

From Processes to Profits: An Operator's View of Finance

Section 1 – Personal Journey

Every book has a story behind it, and mine begins not in a classroom or a boardroom, but in the quiet struggles of everyday survival. I did not come from privilege or stability. Life tested me early, and those tests shaped the way I see work, responsibility, and ultimately, finance.

In 2013, my life changed forever. I lost my mother in an accident, and soon after, my father stepped away, leaving me and my two elder brothers behind. That moment could have broken me, but instead, it built me. My aunt stepped forward as a parent figure and guided us through those difficult years. It was not an easy journey—financial struggles, emotional battles, and the constant fear of the future were daily companions. But those struggles taught me resilience, independence, and the ability to keep moving no matter how hard the road becomes.

These experiences prepared me for my professional life in ways I did not understand at the time. When you learn to survive without parents, you learn discipline, responsibility, and persistence—qualities that later became essential when I entered the corporate world.

After completing my graduation in B.Com (Hons), I stepped into the professional world with Carelon Global Solutions, where I worked for three years as a Claims Associate. At first, it was just a job—a way to support my family and secure our future. But slowly, it became more than that. It became a journey of learning, growth, and transformation. It was here that I began to see how the smallest operational processes could have the biggest financial impact.

Life Lessons Before Work

Before I talk about my professional experiences, it is important to connect them to the life lessons I had already learned. When you lose the safety net of parents at a young age, you quickly realize that every decision matters. There is no one to fall back on, no one to bail you out of mistakes. This mindset made me meticulous, cautious, and detail-oriented—qualities that aligned perfectly with the work I later did in claims adjudication.

I learned resilience: no matter how many setbacks came my way, I had to rise the next morning and keep going. I learned financial responsibility: with limited resources, every rupee had to be spent carefully, a principle I now see mirrored in how companies manage costs and profits. And I learned empathy: living through pain gave me the ability to understand others' struggles, a skill that later helped me in building relationships at work.

Stepping into the Corporate World

When I joined Carelon Global Solutions as a Claims Associate, my role was to adjudicate 143 claims every day, with zero errors. At first, the number itself felt overwhelming. One hundred and forty-three claims—each representing a patient, a provider, and money—passing through my desk every single

day. But I knew something about discipline. I knew how to wake up each morning and keep going, no matter how difficult the task.

In my first year, my manager, who was from West Bengal, helped me understand the importance of accuracy. He reminded me that this was not just routine paperwork—it was the bread and butter for us and for the company. The accuracy of my work determined whether providers got paid on time, whether patients received support, and whether the company maintained its financial credibility. I began to see how what looked like small, repetitive tasks were in fact critical to the company's cash flow and profitability.

In my second year, I worked under another manager, Jitendra, who taught me the art of managing relationships. He showed me that doing the work well was important but so was maintaining good bonds with peers and seniors. Collaboration, respect, and teamwork made the difference between simply surviving at work and thriving. This was another layer of operational excellence: efficiency is not just about individual performance, but also about how well teams function together.

Looking back, I see how my personal life and professional journey are deeply connected. The hardships of my childhood gave me resilience. My education gave me knowledge. And my time at Carelon gave me the professional insights that form the foundation of this book. This is where the journey of linking processes to profits truly began.

Section 2 – Professional Journey at Carelon

The First Desk at Carelon

My first day at Carelon Global Solutions was a mixture of excitement, nervousness, and responsibility. Walking into a large office space, surrounded by screens filled with numbers and claims, I realized that this was going to be a completely different world from what I had known during my academic years. The structured environment, the targets, and the accountability were immediate and clear.

I was told my target: 143 claims per day, with zero errors. At first, it felt impossible. Each claim represented more than just a number—it was tied to patients' treatments, providers' payments, and the company's credibility. To process 143 claims daily meant dealing with accuracy, speed, and consistency, all under the ticking clock of deadlines. That was my welcome into the operations industry.

Learning the Value of Accuracy

In the first year, I was guided by my manager from West Bengal. He was strict, but he was fair. He repeatedly reminded us: this job is our bread and butter, and accuracy is non-negotiable. At first, I didn't fully understand the depth of his words. But as I worked day after day, I saw the consequences of errors. A single miscalculation could delay a provider's payment, could disrupt a patient's care, and could cost the company financially.

Operations, I realized, is not just about completing tasks. It is about protecting the financial integrity of an organization. Every accurate claim ensured smooth cash flow. Every mistake introduced leakage and delays. This was my first big lesson: processes, no matter how small, directly impact profits.

Working Under Pressure

The work was relentless. There were days when backlogs piled up, deadlines closed in, and fatigue tested us. But the system was designed to function only if every individual maintained their share of discipline. I learned to structure my day, to break down 143 claims into smaller achievable goals, and to never let the pressure affect accuracy. Discipline became my strength, not just at work but in life.

In those moments, I understood how operations teach resilience. Unlike in theory, where problems are neatly defined, real-life operational challenges come unannounced and often at scale. Solving them requires calmness, focus, and the willpower to keep going.

The Role of Relationships

In my second year, I worked under another manager, Jitendra. His leadership style was different. While my first manager focused on precision and discipline, Jitendra emphasized people. He showed me that efficiency is not just about working alone at maximum speed—it is also about how you interact with your team. Good relationships with peers meant better collaboration, less conflict, and smoother workflows.

Through his guidance, I realized that operations are as much about teamwork as they are about individual performance. Trust, respect, and clear communication built an environment where processes moved faster and more accurately. This was my second big lesson: relationships are also processes, and when managed well, they too convert into profits.

From Process to Profitability

During my three years, I often reflected on the bigger picture. On the surface, I was just adjudicating claims. But at a deeper level, I was helping maintain the financial flow of a large healthcare operation. If claims were processed on time, providers trusted the system, patients received care without hurdles, and the company maintained its profitability. If claims were delayed, everything slowed down: cash flow, credibility, and satisfaction.

I began to see finance not just as numbers on a balance sheet but as the outcome of thousands of small processes. This operator's view of finance helped me understand the importance of consistency, discipline, and collaboration. Profit is not created in the boardroom—it is created at the operational level, where work is done with accuracy and care.

Growth Over 3 Years

Looking back, my three years at Carelon were transformative. I entered as a nervous graduate, unsure of my role in a large system. I left with confidence, skills, and a mindset that operations and finance are inseparable. I grew not just as an employee but as a professional ready to see the bigger picture.

The resilience from my personal life combined with the discipline of my professional journey. It became clear that no matter how challenging circumstances may be, consistent effort and clear processes eventually lead to success.

Section 3 – From Operations to Finance

The Turning Point

By the time I completed my third year at Carelon Global Solutions, I had reached a point of clarity. What once felt like a simple job—processing claims, meeting daily targets, and listening to managers—began to reveal a deeper truth. Operations was not just about following steps in a system. It was about creating a flow that sustained the financial health of the company.

When I first joined Carelon, I thought finance was something far away—handled by senior managers in glass-walled offices. They were the ones, I assumed, who talked about revenue, profits, and balance sheets. But as I settled into my role, I realized that the foundation of those financial results was built in places like my desk. Finance did not start in reports. It started in processes.

Every single claim I adjudicated was not just a task to close—it was a financial transaction with ripple effects. One correct claim moved money smoothly from the insurer to the provider. One mistake delayed payments, created rework, and sometimes even eroded trust in the system. That was finance in motion, and I was right at its heart.

Understanding the Connection

Operations and finance often appear to be different worlds. One is about execution, discipline, and consistency. The other is about strategy, numbers, and forecasting. But they are two sides of the same coin.

If operations stumble, finance suffers. If finance becomes disconnected from operations, strategies fall flat. This connection was not something I read in a textbook—it was something I lived.

For example, in claims processing, a delay of even one day could cause providers to wait longer for reimbursement. This waiting affected their own financial cycles—staff salaries, equipment payments, and even patient services. Multiply that delay across thousands of claims, and you begin to see how operational inefficiencies can shake financial stability.

On the other hand, smooth, error-free operations created predictability. Providers trusted the company more. Cash flow stabilized. And senior leadership had confidence in their financial reports. In short: finance lived in every single process, and processes determined financial outcomes.

Accuracy and Cash Flow

In finance, cash flow is often called the lifeline of business. For me, accuracy was the heart that kept that lifeline pumping.

At Carelon, my target was to process 143 claims a day—without error. That number was not just a performance metric. It represented the pace at which money could move through the system. Each accurate claim kept the financial cycle turning. Each error, however small, created blockages.

I still remember one specific incident. A colleague made a minor error in the coding of a claim. It seemed small at first, but the mistake led to a rejection that had to be reprocessed. The provider grew frustrated, the patient called in to complain, and several extra hours were spent fixing something that could have been done right the first time. That error did not just waste time—it cost money, credibility, and trust. From that day forward, I began to treat each claim as if it carried the weight of the company's profitability. Because it did. Accuracy was not optional. It was the foundation of financial health.

Speed and Efficiency

Accuracy alone was not enough. Speed mattered just as much. When I looked at my target of 143 claims per day, I realized that time was my most valuable currency. Each minute spent inefficiently on one claim was a minute taken away from the rest. If I rushed and made errors, I slowed the cycle later through rework. If I went too slowly, I risked creating backlogs that affected the team and the company.

Over time, I learned that efficiency is not about working faster blindly—it is about working smarter. I began to structure my workflow in ways that minimized distractions, reduced repeated steps, and allowed me to stay focused. That efficiency translated into financial outcomes. Faster processing meant faster reimbursements. Faster reimbursements meant providers trusted Carelon more. And stronger trust meant stronger business relationships. Operations, when done with efficiency, became liquidity in action.

Collaboration as a Financial Tool

At first glance, teamwork does not look like a financial tool. It feels like a soft skill, something human resources might talk about in workshops. But I learned otherwise.

My second manager, Jitendra, emphasized the importance of relationships—with peers, seniors, and even across departments. I began to see why. When the team worked well together, problems were solved faster. Knowledge was shared. Mistakes were caught before they reached the next stage. Stress was reduced.

That collaboration had direct financial consequences. A cohesive team avoided delays, reworks, and conflicts that could slow down operations. And in finance, time is money. Every hour saved by teamwork was an hour added to profitability.

Jitendra's advice taught me that collaboration is not just about harmony. It is about productivity. And productivity is profit.

The Operator's View of Finance

Through these experiences, my view of finance changed forever.

Finance was not just about profit margins, revenue growth, or EBITDA. It was about the discipline of processes, the accuracy of data, the efficiency of workflows, and the strength of teamwork.

I began to see profit not as something created in financial statements, but as something born in the trenches of daily operations. Profit began at my desk, in every claim processed correctly and on time. Finance was not distant—it was right there in front of me.

This realization gave me a new perspective: operations is not separate from finance—it is the foundation of finance. Companies that invest in their processes, train their people, and build cultures of accuracy and collaboration naturally create sustainable profits.

Preparing for the Future

These lessons were not just professional—they were personal. Coming from a life where I lost my parents early, where survival itself was a challenge, I saw operations as more than work. It was discipline, resilience, and persistence in action. The hardships of my personal life had trained me to

endure pressure, and my professional life showed me how that endurance translated into value for organizations.

By the end of three years at Carelton, I knew my journey was only beginning. I wanted to connect what I had learned on the operational floor with the frameworks of finance and strategy that are taught in business schools.

Pursuing an MBA became my next step—not just as a career move, but to transform lived experiences into leadership insights. I wanted to carry forward the operator’s view of finance, to help organizations see that profitability is not built in quarterly reports—it is built in daily processes, by people who care about their work. And so, I move forward with this belief: operations is where profits are born, and finance is how those profits are sustained.

Section 4 – Broader Lessons for Companies and Young Professionals

Why Lessons Matter

Stories inspire, but lessons guide. After three years of processing claims at Carelton, and after a life shaped by hardship and resilience, I realized that my experiences had meaning beyond myself. They held lessons for two groups of people:

1. Companies that want to improve their profitability and efficiency.
2. Young professionals who are beginning their careers and looking for direction.

This section is my attempt to share those lessons in clear, practical language.

Lesson 1: Profitability Begins with Processes

Most companies think of profitability as something shaped by big decisions—new product launches, mergers, pricing strategies. While these are important, the truth is simpler: profitability begins with processes. When frontline employees like claim associates make fewer errors, companies save money. When teams meet deadlines, customer satisfaction improves. When workflows are efficient, cash flow is smoother. These “small” details, repeated thousands of times each day, add up to millions in savings or losses.

For companies: Invest in your processes. Train your people. Respect the details.

For young professionals: Understand that even small tasks matter. Your discipline in small processes today builds the foundation for leadership tomorrow.

Lesson 2: Accuracy Is Cheaper Than Correction

One of my managers used to say, “Do it right the first time.” I only understood its full weight after seeing how costly errors could be. A single wrong claim meant delays, angry calls, wasted hours, and sometimes even financial penalties. Accuracy, therefore, is not just about pride—it is a cost-saving tool.

It is cheaper to do things right the first time than to spend hours fixing mistakes later. For companies: Create cultures where accuracy is valued. Don't reward only speed; reward error-free work. For young professionals: Slow down to be correct. Speed without accuracy is wasted effort.

Lesson 3: Efficiency Is a Financial Strategy

At Carelon, efficiency was not about rushing. It was about structuring work smartly avoiding repeated steps, minimizing distractions, and focusing on outcomes. That efficiency directly translated into faster cash flow and stronger financial performance. Efficiency is often seen as an operational principle, but it is also a financial strategy. Efficient companies have stronger liquidity, healthier margins, and happier stakeholders. For companies: Redesign workflows to reduce waste. Small time savings across teams compound into massive financial benefits. For young professionals: Develop personal efficiency systems. The habits you build early—time management, focus, prioritization—will multiply your impact later.

Lesson 4: Collaboration Creates Profit

One of the most surprising discoveries in my career was how teamwork influenced profitability. When teams collaborated, knowledge was shared, mistakes were caught early, and problems were solved faster. When teams clashed, inefficiencies multiplied. This showed me that collaboration is not just about harmony—it is about financial results. Good teamwork saves time, and in business, time is money. For companies: Invest in team culture. Create structures where collaboration is encouraged and rewarded. For young professionals: Build good relationships. Treat peers and superiors with respect. In the long run, your network is as valuable as your skills.

Lesson 5: Resilience Is the Real Competitive Advantage

My life has taught me resilience. Losing my parents, being raised by my aunt, working hard to graduate, and handling a demanding role at Carelon—all of this showed me that survival requires strength. And survival is not just personal; it is organizational too.

Resilient companies survive crises. Resilient employees adapt to change. In today's world, resilience is the most underappreciated yet essential competitive advantage. For companies: Build resilience into your systems. Prepare for crises by training teams, creating buffers, and empowering decision-making. For young professionals: Develop personal resilience. Learn from setbacks. Stay consistent under pressure. Your ability to endure will define your career more than any single achievement.

Lesson 6: Finance Is Not Just Numbers—it's People and Processes

When I started, I thought finance meant balance sheets and reports. But now I know finance is built on people and processes. A company's numbers are simply the reflection of how well its people execute and how strong its processes are. This is why operators like claim associates matter. Their discipline creates the foundation for financial success.

For companies: Look beyond the reports. Ask yourself: are your frontline employees empowered, trained, and motivated? That's where finance is born.

For young professionals: Don't undervalue your work. Even if you are at the entry level, remember that your work contributes directly to the company's financial story.

The Operator's Legacy

If I could summarize my three years at Cargill in one sentence, it would be this: Operations is where profits are born, and finance is how those profits are sustained. This belief has shaped not just my professional outlook but also my future ambitions. It is why I want to pursue an MBA—not just to learn theories, but to connect what I have lived with what I can lead.

I want companies to see that investing in their processes is not just about efficiency—it is about profitability. I want young professionals to see that their work matters deeply, no matter how small it may feel today.

Concluding Reflections: You Can Survive Anything

Life has not been easy for me. Losing both parents, struggling through education, and shouldering responsibilities at a young age could have broken me. But instead, they built me. My challenges did not define my limits—they revealed my strength. This is the message I want every reader to take away: you can survive anything. If I, a boy without parents, can grow into a professional connecting processes and finance, then so can you. Resilience, discipline, and belief are stronger than any obstacle. Processes create profits. But in life, perseverance creates success and with this understanding, I look forward to my next chapter—not just as an operator, but as a future leader who sees finance through the eyes of operations.